Yellow

Lightness · confidence · ideas

Yellow can recall summer, sun on a wall and lightness. But also a moment when you have had enough of everything and the last thing you need is another cheerful “come on, smile”. Sometimes you are drawn to it precisely because you lack liveliness. At other times it feels too sharp, conspicuous or childish.

This page does not tell you what yellow means. **It shows it to you from several sides**. How it is mixed, how you paint with it, where its strength comes from, how it is read in different cultures and **what it can awaken in us**.

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How to mix the colour and its shades

In painting yellow is one of the basic colours. **It is easiest to start with yellow from the tube** and look for the form you want to give it. From red and blue alone you cannot mix a pure yellow. The proportions are approximate, every brand behaves a little differently, so **try them out on paper first**.

What to prepare

Lemon yellow
Cooler, sometimes with a slight lean towards green.

Warm yellow
Closer to the sun, egg yolk and orange.

Yellow ochre
An earthy pigment that is already more muted in itself.

White
For light and gentler shades.

Red or orange
For warmer yellows.

Earthy brown
For earthy, mustard and honey mixes.

Blue
Added very carefully, because it quickly pushes yellow towards green.

How can you recognise it without technical names?

Put several yellow samples side by side.

Lemon can recall the peel of a lemon. **Sunflower** tends to be warmer and fuller. **Butter** is light and soft. **Mustard** is more muted, with a brownish or greenish tint. **Ochre** already strongly recalls soil.

Names on tubes are not a uniform recipe. “Sun yellow” from one maker can look different from another's. A small sample helps, and next to it the same colour mixed with white. A touch of white often shows the undertone that you can easily overlook in thick paint.

On some tubes you will find the mark PY and a number, that is, the designation of a yellow pigment. Two colours with a similar name do not have to contain the same pigment.

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What the additions do



White

Lightens it and shifts it towards butter and vanilla. Add it a little at a time, yellow easily gets lost under a stronger pigment.

→



Orange

Warms. Sunflower and golden yellow.

→ 



Red

Leads to warmer, darker yellows. A strong pigment, add it carefully.

→ 



Ochre

An earthy pigment that mutes yellow. Golden, sandy.

→ 



Brown

For earthy, mustard and honey mixes. It can take command very quickly.

→ 



Blue

Pushes yellow towards yellow-green. Add it on the tip of the brush.

→ 



Violet

Its opposite on the colour wheel. A drop (roughly 1 part to 20 parts yellow) calms it into a grey-yellow.

→ 

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Ten yellows to try

A part means an equally large portion of paint, a drop or a heap. Take the proportions as the start of an experiment. Every colour from a tube has a different strength; brown, red and blue in particular can take command very quickly.

Soft lemon



4 parts white + 1 part lemon yellow. Light, fresh, spring-like.

Butter



5 parts white + 1 part warm yellow. Soft, kind.

Vanilla



8 parts white + 1 part warm yellow + a tiny trace of ochre. Quiet, creamy.

Sunflower



10 parts warm yellow + 1 part orange. Rich, warming. The proportion is my approximate suggestion, adjust it by the orange from the tube.

Golden yellow



4 parts warm yellow + a trace of orange and brown. Festive, warm.

Honey



3 parts warm yellow + a small amount of ochre and brown. Thick, kind.

Mustard



3 parts yellow + brown added gradually; possibly a little white. Earthy, retro.

Earthy ochre mix



3 parts yellow + 1 part earthy brown; adjust with white. Clay, caves. The proportion is my approximate suggestion.

Sand



6 parts white + 1 part ochre; a little yellow if needed. Calm, natural.

Yellow-green



4 parts lemon yellow + the very tip of blue. Fresh, sour, approaching green.

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Rainbow – the chakra system

In the usual order of the seven colours yellow is between orange and green. In the current rainbow map of the chakras it belongs **to the third chakra** and the themes of self-worth, **will and decision-making**.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions

Red · root
Safety, support, presence. Ask yourself. Do I have something to lean on? What gives me a sense of safety right now?

Orange · sacral
Experiencing, pleasure, creating. Ask yourself. What does me good? Where do I allow myself joy?

Yellow · solar plexus
Self-worth, will. Ask yourself. What do I want? Where do I need to stand up for myself?

Green · heart
Closeness, relationships. Ask yourself. How am I with myself? Whom do I let close?

Blue · throat
Voice, expression. Ask yourself. What do I need to say? What do I no longer want to swallow?

Indigo · third eye
Inner vision, intuition. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?

Violet · crown
Meaning, transcendence, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me meaning? What do I feel connected to?

Orange may ask “what delights me?”, yellow “**will I allow myself** to want it?” and green “how do I **stay kind to myself and others** while doing so?”

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Manipura, the solar plexus chakra

Chakras come from the **Indian yoga and tantric tradition**. **The third chakra is called Manipura** (in Sanskrit “city of jewels”). It dwells in the area of the navel and solar plexus. The **element of fire**, the sound **syllable RAM** and a lotus with ten petals belong to it, which the classical descriptions give as dark blue or black, “like heavy rain clouds”. Yellow is linked with it mainly in today's view, although a yellow circle also appears in the traditional depiction (the red triangle of fire in a yellow circle). Sources differ in details.

Its theme is **fire, transformation, personal power and will**. For women this is often translated into questions. **Do I have the right** to my own opinion and to stand behind it? **Can I ask** for my place? **Do I know what I want**?

This does not mean you have to be the loudest in the room. Sometimes the greater expression of your own strength is quiet.

When it is open. You know what you want and can say it. You trust your abilities and do not have to keep comparing yourself. Your **energy flows** and you make decisions without long hesitation.

When it is closed. The tradition describes insecurity, a need for approval from others, a fear of mistakes or, on the contrary, a need to control. Closed does not mean bad. It is only a signal that perhaps you do not yet allow yourself to take your place.

How to add yellow when you are missing confidence

- **Wear it**
  A yellow scarf, jumper or earrings. Something that makes you stand out but does not shout.
- **Put it in your home**
  A yellow cushion, flower or mug. Fresh lemons on the table.
- **Eat it**
  Lemons, sweetcorn, bananas, pumpkin, turmeric. With relish and in peace.
- **Treat yourself to some sun**
  Five minutes in the sun, a window that lets in the morning light.
- **Paint it**
  A large yellow area in the middle of the paper. A sun that is allowed to be big.
- **Fit it into the morning**
  A yellow mug at breakfast, a napkin or a spoon. A small flash of light at the start of the day.

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How to top up or take away yellow when you are already the hamster in the cage?

When your head is running at full revs, **you do not need more yellow, but something that slows you down**.

- **Mute the yellow**
  Replace a rich one with butter, sand or ochre. Add green or blue. Calm and a breath. A plant, water, a blue blanket.

- **Add brown**
  Support and stability. Wood, natural materials, the ground under your feet.

When your own will gets lost

Modern interpretations describe a weakened or “closed” manipura as an image of self-distrust, indecision and leaving your own direction to others. If you want to work with this image, **you can try** a short exercise with colour.

When the inner fire burns you more than it warms

The image of an overactive manipura is used for excessive control, competitiveness or a need to keep proving your worth.

Perhaps you rest, but you check whether you are resting efficiently enough. You finish one thing and instead of **satisfaction** you are already looking for the next. When someone does things differently, you feel like taking it out of their hands at once.

Here the advice “add even more radiant yellow” could miss what you need.

Instead of further encouragement, try softening the whole experience. Swap lemon for butter, a large area for a small detail, a sharp contrast for a calmer companion.

If green, cream or a muted blue is pleasant to you, hold it next to the yellow and compare the feeling. Sometimes you need less intensity, not a different symbol.

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A short moment with the colour yellow

Sit down **comfortably** and put a yellow fabric or paper in front of you. Let your breath be natural.

Notice the colour for a while. Then **you can** close your eyes and imagine a small soft sun in the area of your belly. It does not have to light up the whole city. It is enough if it is pleasant for you.

If you are rather losing yourself at the moment, **you can** let it take up a little more space in your imagination. If you are pushing yourself, let its light soften.

If you want to add sound, **you can** quietly say **RAM** on a **comfortable** exhale. The voice does not have to be strong, the exhale long or the feeling extraordinary. The sound can give attention a simple point to return to.

At the end open your eyes and look around. **Notice** whether you feel the same, more pleasant, or whether this form of work does not suit you.

Can I connect yellow with another chakra?

In symbolic work **you can** connect the themes of individual colours.

- **Yellow and red**
  Your own decision together with support. Good for reflection when you know what you want but are afraid of losing security.
- **Yellow and orange**
  Decision-making together with pleasure. When you can fulfil tasks but have forgotten that you may also want something for joy.
- **Yellow and green**
  Self-worth together with closeness. When you feel that standing up for yourself means hurting someone.
- **Yellow and blue**
  Decision together with expression. When you are already clear but the words still stay inside.
- **Yellow and indigo**
  Will together with inner vision. When you know what is proper but something quietly leads elsewhere.
- **Yellow and violet**
  Action together with meaning. When you do a lot and begin to lose the answer to the question why.

This is work with meaning and your own experience. It has not been shown that by adding a specific colour you measurably regulate a chakra.

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And ask yourself

Do I know what I want, or mainly what is expected of me?

Do I need more **courage** to decide today, or less pressure on myself?

When do I allow myself to be content with myself without having finished something else first?

Picture it with an example

Next to yellow other colours can feel brighter. Blue calms it, green softens it and violet highlights it. **These are possibilities of personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a colour combination.

How to use this map

You **do not have to** go through all the colours or find one right one. Stop at the theme that touches you right now.

Perhaps yellow attracts you, but while reading you find that you do know how to decide. What you lack is rather the **courage** to voice your decision. Then blue may interest you too.

Or you have plans enough but nowhere to draw strength from. At such a moment the theme of support may be more important than another prompt to perform.

The map is meant to help you tell apart your own needs. It is not meant to turn your choice of colour into a verdict.

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Free painting – intuition

When we paint freely, with no goal and no effort to have a pretty and perfect picture, yellow often appears when we want to **light** something up, **think** something up or simply **breathe out**.

In free painting there is no need to know in advance what you are expressing. First **you can** paint. Meaning may appear later — and sometimes it does not appear at all.

What may be hiding behind a yellow stroke

The same yellow line on paper can mean **something completely different every time** – depending on what is going on in us at the moment. Sometimes it is **joy**, sometimes **restlessness**, sometimes the pure taste of the colour. That is why there is no point in reading a painting like a test with **a single correct answer**.

Joy and lightness

Small light strokes, sparks, rays running out from one place. The paper is light and spacious.

Ideas and flashes

Zigzags, stars, short punchy strokes. Like when something occurs to you that you want to capture at once.

Confidence and being seen

A large bright area in the middle of the paper, a sun that has nothing against shining.

Overload and nervousness

Lots of yellow strokes over one another, sharp edges, sometimes with black. The head running at full power.

Bitterness and envy

A sour, greenish yellow, narrow strokes pushing towards something. When you feel sorry about something and do not want to admit it.

Tiredness and fading

A pale, washed-out yellow, a stroke that disappears at the end. A colour in which there is almost no sun left.

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Yellow in a painting. Can it express what is happening inside?

Yes, it can – but it does not have to. When painting you sometimes reach for a colour before you can name what you feel. Yellow can then give form to **joy**, to ideas and a longing for light, but also to a feeling that you have to be cheerful all the time.

Equally it can simply be a pretty colour that you happened to have to hand that day. Meaning comes only in connection with your experience. **The colour itself does not know what happened to you**. You do – or you will work it out in time.

Art therapy also works with the idea that a picture can express something for which words are hard to find. What matters is not a single patch of colour but **the whole picture** and how it came to be. Your situation, memories, the movement of your hand and your feelings while painting.

A predominance of yellow alone is not enough for a verdict on whether it is **joy** or the need to be cheerful. Perhaps you were in a good mood. Perhaps you wanted to light up a grey sheet of paper. And perhaps you simply enjoyed that yellow so much that grey had no chance that day.

I want it on the canvas, but I don't dare put it on myself

A yellow painting and a yellow jumper may ask two completely different things of you. On canvas you give space to experience. In clothing **you may** feel that you are visible and that cheerfulness is expected of you. That is why a large yellow area in a painting can attract you while the thought of walking out among people in a yellow coat frightens you.

That is entirely fine. In creating, **you can** thus more easily try out a boldness you do not yet want to wear on your body. No obligatory wardrobe makeover has to follow. Perhaps it is enough for you that this part of you has a place on the canvas.

Only later **you may** notice whether you are tempted to carry a bit of that experience into life. For example through earrings, a yellow scarf or a flower on the table.

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When yellow takes over the space

First let the hand work. **You do not have to paint joy** or a little sun. Yellow can quite well be a large unnamed area. The interpretation can wait and you do not have to choose the right reason before you touch the canvas.

Three things worth noticing

QUANTITY

A small trace, or a large area?

How much space yellow gets today. A small yellow trace in the middle of a large area can be more important to you than a whole yellow painting. It may recall something precious, fragile, distant or newly emerging. A large area can be pleasantly full, warm and free, but it can also start to feel too insistent. A lot of yellow does not automatically mean a lot of joy, and a little yellow does not mean a lack of life force.

SATURATION

A sharp lemon, or butter?

A striking yellow may be exactly what you want today. A bright trace that does not get lost. At other times a yellow with white, an ochre or a mix that no longer has such a sharp look will feel better. If relief appears after you add white, that very change may be important to you. Not as a rule “I needed less energy”, but as a specific realisation “This feels closer to me today.”

THICKNESS

Thick, or translucent?

Thick paint offers a different resistance when you work than thin. You may enjoy its body, coverage and the trace of the hand or tool. You may want to press, layer and feel that something is really coming into being under your hands. A translucent yellow offers a different experience. The ground shows through, colours overlap and individual layers remain visible. Neither is a personality test. A thick layer alone does not mean accumulated anger and a translucent colour does not mean insecurity.

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What to take from the picture

It does not matter how the yellow stroke looks. **What matters is what you feel while making it**, what situation you are in and what is happening in your life right now. Two identical paintings can have a completely different meaning. One came from an idea that lit you up, the other after a day when you tried to stay positive all the time. That is why you will not find a dictionary here, but questions.

When the painting speaks only later

After finishing **you may** feel **relief**, **satisfaction**, tiredness or nothing special at all. Sometimes you only notice after several days that the yellow area attracts you differently. You can return to the painting in a different state of mind.

What to take from the picture

Looking back later **you can** connect the painting with what was happening then. You may recall, for example, that for the first time in a long while you painted without trying to please anyone. Or that yellow, on the contrary, irritated you and a blue area brought **relief**.

This way of self-reflection is inspired by work with experience in art therapy. You look for meaning in your experience, not in a table that would assign the same translation to every yellow stroke.

You can try a favourite combination outside the painting too. First on fabrics, clothing or a small object. A canvas is not an order to repaint the kitchen.

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Associations and stories

Our associations

Associations are things that link themselves to a colour almost by themselves. **Nobody is born with them**, and yet they tend to be surprisingly similar. They are taken from three places. From the body, from culture and from what we have lived through.

From the body

Yellow is the colour of the sun and of day, and also the lightest of the colours we see. That is exactly why the eye catches it before others, and why it is used everywhere something should draw attention. **Yellow says: Here is light and something is happening.** At the same time, though, it is so bright that it is hard to look at for long, especially large areas.

From culture

In Europe, Canada and the USA yellow is most often linked with **joy**, humour and spontaneity. Alongside that it also carries less pleasant meanings. **Envy**, hypocrisy, greed and in the USA cowardice. **In China and elsewhere in Asia it is on the contrary the colour of emperors, wisdom and harmony. The same colour can thus mean glory and shame. It depends on where we grew up.** We will look at this in more detail in the section on cultures.

From what you have lived

A yellow umbrella from childhood, a kitchen at grandmother's, a yellow marker from school, a hospital glove, a yellow note with a task. **These memories decide the most.** Two women can look at the same yellow and **one feels joy, the other stress** from having to get everything done all the time.

When you know where your associations come from, it is easier to tell what is actually “yellow” and what is your story about it.

Stories

Yellow has a few interesting stories. Some of them are worth untangling, because they show **where the colour ends and where we begin**, we and our brain.

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A word related to gold

The English word yellow comes from Old English geolu and shares a root with the words gold and yell (a shout). The oldest known record is from around the year 700. Yellow and gold are thus related in language. What shines golden got a name similar to what shouts.

The yellow card and the traffic light

The referee Ken Aston devised the yellow and red card after the traffic light. Yellow means caution, red means stop. They were first used at the 1970 World Cup in Mexico. The idea reportedly came from unclear communication at the quarter-final in 1966. **Yellow says: You may still, but we have noticed you.**

The yellow school bus

In 1939 Professor Frank Cyr called a conference at Columbia University to unify standards for school buses. From shades ranging from lemon to orange-red three yellows were selected and finally a golden yellow, because it is most visible in the morning and towards evening.

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Emotions and feelings

The same yellow can awaken **joy in one of us and nervousness in another**, sometimes even both in one day.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

Joy and lightness

A feeling of brightening, as when the sun comes out. The body straightens up and a smile comes by itself.

And why?

It can recall experiences in which you felt good. When you bring home yellow tulips, it is not just their shade that delights you. You chose them, put them in a vase and did something nice for yourself.

If I asked you now

"When did you last just smile?"

Confidence and the courage to be seen

The wish to step out of line and say what I think. A feeling that I have the right to take my place.

And why?

Yellow is the lightest colour and the eye strays to it first. **To be yellow is to be seen.**

Ask yourself

"Where do I hide, even though I would like to shine?"

Ideas and intuition

Flashes and hunches. **A feeling that I know, even though I could not explain it.**

And why?

Jung linked intuition with gold or yellow, because it is "felt as radiant".

Try asking yourself

"When did I last do something even despite my inner voice saying "This is going to be a disaster"?"

Optimism, or compulsory positivity?

Great and positive – but at what cost?

And why?

Yellow is linked with **joy** and humour. That easily turns into a role that is hard to step out of afterwards.

Ask yourself

"Is my good mood real, or am I acting it?"

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Feelings and experience

Less immediate than emotions. They say more about how we feel in a situation, in the body and in relation to ourselves.

Nervousness and an overloaded head

The head is running at full revs and there is already a proper knot in the belly. A feeling that I cannot cope with anything, that I cannot keep up.

And why?

In tradition yellow is linked with the area of the belly (the solar plexus) and **with personal power,** but also with **worries**. A rich yellow can drive and chase us quite a bit.

A question for you

"What happens in your belly when you are supposed to say your opinion, or stand behind it?"

Envy and bitterness

A sharp feeling that the other woman has more (**courage**, strength, simply everything...), and straight after it shame. In yellow there is simply also a bit of sour green.

And why?

In Europe yellow has long been linked also with **envy** and hypocrisy, since the Middle Ages for example with Judas.

If I asked you now

"Whom do you envy lately? And for what? And why?"

When you suddenly crave yellow

After days full of duties you may be drawn to something fresh and playful. Yellow may remind you of summer, warmth or moments when you had more time for yourself. Perhaps that is exactly the feeling that is missing.

Why, on the contrary, does its cheerfulness bother me?

When you are **sad**, tired or under pressure, **an impression that is too cheerful can feel alien. As if the surroundings were telling a story that does not meet your inner world at the moment.**

Perhaps you were told for a long time "smile", "think positive" or "others have it worse". Then a striking yellow can carry for you also an **unpleasant** reminder that a good mood is expected of you.

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My yellow is not the same as your yellow

The colour itself experiences nothing. You experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the experience sticks to it. **The colour then becomes a shortcut. One glimpse is enough and the body knows whether it can relax or should pull back.**

- **A yellow note with a task**
  For one a help so she does not forget, for another an endless list that cannot be completed.
- **A yellow marker**
  For one learning and clear notes, for another exam stress.
- **A yellow warning sign**
  For one safety and attention, for another a reminder of danger.
- **A yellow kitchen at grandmother's**
  For one home and warmth, for another something old she wants to run away from.

Some colours we put aside. After a hard period we get rid of a dress or avoid a place. **It is a way of protecting ourselves. And when we are ready, yellow often comes back by itself, first as a bouquet on the table, then as a scarf.**

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Yellow in cultures and traditions

Yellow is a colour that in history has been a crown, a badge of **shame** and a vest of protest. **The same colour, opposing stories.** Let us look attentively and gently at a few places, because some of these stories are **painful**.

This chapter therefore shows **two levels**. First, how yellow is read in different **cultures**, and then how **traditional systems** look at it, using it as an image.

Yellow in different cultures

China

In imperial China yellow had a prominent position. Under the Qing dynasty the colours of court dress determined rank and belonging to the imperial circle. Bright yellow belonged to the highest members of the imperial family; other shades had their designations too.

So it was not only a question of whether something matched someone's eyes. Clothing told you who stood before you and what place they had in the social order.

Here yellow is connected with authority, exceptionality and standing.

For your own reflection it offers a different image than a cheerful dandelion. It can recall **dignity** and the right to take your place.

At the same time it shows how the meaning of a colour is created by society. The power of imperial robes lay not only in the shade but also in the rules, ceremonies and power of its wearer.

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India

At the festival of Vasant Panchami, linked with the arrival of spring and the worship of the goddess Saraswati, yellow has a significant place. It appears in clothing and festive decoration. Saraswati is associated with learning, music and the arts.

Yellow here can carry an image of awakening and openness to the new.

For our guide the connection of **joy** and discovery is interesting. Learning does not have to be only something that must be mastered correctly. It can also be pleasant exploring.

You **can** set aside a yellow notebook for things that interest you. Without every interest having to become a course, a certificate or a business plan within a week.

Thailand

In the traditional Thai assigning of colours to days, yellow belongs to Monday. From this comes its use at some royal celebrations connected with a monarch born on a Monday.

Yellow clothing in such a setting can express belonging and **respect**.

At first glance you see a colour. Only knowing the custom shows why so many people suddenly have it.

That is a good reminder for everyday life. **Not every colour choice says something about mood. Sometimes it expresses belonging, tradition or a shared event.**

The Christian Middle Ages

Medieval Europe perceived yellow in two ways. Thanks to its similarity to gold it had a good reputation and appeared in heraldry.

In the late Middle Ages, though, it also acquired a dark side. Judas, who betrayed Jesus, appears in paintings more and more often in yellow clothing. Yellow then began to be linked with **envy** and betrayal.

The same colour could thus at the same time mean light and **shame**, depending on who it was put on.

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Yellow in traditional systems

Every tradition looks at yellow **a little differently**, but all take it seriously. It is an old symbolic language and a source of inspiration, not a healing guide.

Traditional Chinese medicine

In the system of five elements yellow is linked with earth. To this circle belong **the spleen and stomach**, the taking in of food and its transformation into what nourishes a person.

The names of organs here denote traditional functional circles. It is not the same description as in modern anatomy.

Earth is also linked with the period of late summer and with the transitions between seasons. Imagine a ripe field, the harvest and the moment when what has grown provides nourishment.

In this view yellow is not merely a prompt to activity. It is also a question of what you actually live on.

Everyone has enough. And you?

You know what everyone needs. You shop, arrange, listen, remind. At work you catch a problem before the others. At home you think about what else to do.

But you eat between doors yourself and put off pleasant things until the time when nothing is needed.

You **do not have to** have a family to recognise yourself in this. **You can** be long-term adapting to work, customers, parents or the idea that you must manage everything without help.

Care easily becomes one-way traffic.

The theme of earth also recalls receiving. Of food, support, rest, company and ordinary interest in you.

When worries keep coming back

In traditional interpretations earth also has a place for brooding. For everyday life **you can** notice the difference between thinking that leads to a decision and a worry that keeps going round in circles.

You can use yellow for a simple distinction. On one yellow sheet write what you **can** really do today. Put the other notes aside.

The point is not to heal the spleen with a piece of paper. The point is to stop demanding of yourself that everything be solved at once.

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Simple tips

Food. Take your favourite yellow bowl and really sit down. If you link it with **well-being**, it can help create a pleasant start to a moment for yourself. Nourishment, though, is determined by the food, not by its colour match with the bowl.

Space. Try a butter or ochre detail by the place where you rest. A soft fabric and a warm shade may be more pleasant than a sharp lemon on a large area.

Making. Try yellow with clay, ochre or brown. If earthiness delights you, this combination may be closer to you than a radiant yellow with black.

Receiving. When someone offers you help, **notice** your first answer. You **do not have to** automatically say “I can manage”. Sometimes accepting support is exactly what long-term giving needs to be topped up with.

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Ayurveda

Ayurveda-inspired work with colours starts from the qualities of warmth, cold, **lightness**, heaviness, movement and stability. Colour recommendations differ between authors.

For this guide it is useful to watch whether a certain form of yellow pleasantly enlivens you or adds more intensity.

Vata · when there is a lot of everything and nothing stops

Vata is traditionally linked with movement and changeability.

For colour self-reflection imagine a day full of moving about, messages and things in progress. At such a moment a soft butter, ochre and familiar natural materials may be more pleasant to you than neon yellow patterns.

Try a warm fabric, a simple setting and one activity. Yellow here can accompany **cosiness**. It does not have to push you.

Pitta · when determination turns into pressure

Pitta is linked with fire and intensity.

When you are already **irritated**, competitive or strict with yourself, **you may** feel like toning down the striking surroundings too.

Try less rich yellows, more free space or the company of a colour that you yourself perceive as calmer. For example muted greens.

There is no need to drive yellow out of the house. Sometimes it is enough for it to stop being in charge of the shift.

Kapha · when there is too much stability

Kapha is traditionally linked with earth, water and stability.

For your own reflection imagine a period when everything is familiar, **comfortable** and a little without movement. A more striking yellow detail can be a welcome change, if it delights you.

Put a yellow flower in a place you walk past without noticing. **Try** a lighter textile. Take something on a walk that feels alive to you.

A colour prompt can accompany change. By itself it neither determines nor treats a dosha.

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A Jungian view

Carl Gustav Jung, the Swiss psychiatrist, understood colours as symbols that have two layers. A personal one (what we have experienced with the colour) and one shared by all people (images that repeat across ages and cultures).

In lectures at ETH in Zurich he linked colours with the functions of the psyche. Of intuition he said “Intuition is gold or yellow, because it is felt as radiant and shining.” Red for him belonged to feeling, blue or white to thinking and green to sensory perception. In the mandalas of the patient Kristine Mann he described yellow as meaning intuition, and wrote of gold that it expresses sunlight, value, even divinity.

How it relates to the colour yellow. Yellow may remind you. Trust the flash that came to you. Intuition is not something that can be proved. It is a hunch that comes from somewhere inside.

What you can take from it. When you are in your head and analysing everything, yellow in the form of flashes helps. **Write down the first idea, do not explain it**. When on the contrary you live only in hunches and finish nothing, green (the senses, the body) or blue (thinking) may do you good.

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Feng shui

Feng shui is the Chinese art of arranging a space so that it is good to live in. Yellow is traditionally linked with the element of **earth** and with the centre. In the map of the house called the bagua the centre, northeast and southwest belong to earth. In a home yellow is therefore often the colour of **stability**, **warmth** and **the shared table**. **Sources differ.**

Yellow is like a spice

A little can bind the whole together, a large quantity determines the taste of everything else.

Before you paint a whole room, hold up a larger sample or a yellow fabric and look at it in the morning, afternoon and evening. Notice whether the space feels closer to you, or whether your gaze keeps returning to one spot that is beginning to keep you busy.

Simple tips

- **Want more light?**
  Add one yellow piece where you will see it every day.
- **Want more calm?**
  Choose butter, vanilla or sand and leave the rich one just for a detail.
- **Is it already too much?**
  Add wood, linen, cream, green or more free space.
- **Want more ideas?**
  Put a yellow notebook or notes where you think and plan nothing with it.

And above all. Before you repaint a whole room, try **a throw**, **a fabric** or a larger colour **sample**. Your feeling is more important than the rules.

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What people say and what holds true

MYTH Yellow always cheers you up.

TRUTH A soft butter and vanilla, yes. A rich lemon can tire the eyes and in a small room feel almost insistent.

MYTH Yellow is a colour just for children.

TRUTH Mustard, ochre and golden are adult and muted. In a children's room a gentle one is usually better than a garish one.

MYTH A yellow room is always lighter.

TRUTH Soft shades reflect light, but a rich yellow can feel heavy. The direction of the windows and the light matter too, not just the colour.

What yellow works well with

- **Wood, linen and cream**
  soften a bright yellow and give it a natural texture.
- **Clay, ochre and brown**
  support an earthy impression. When all the shades are muted and dark, though, the whole can feel tired.
- **Green**
  recalls leaves and flowers. Lemon with a fresh green will be livelier than butter with sage.
- **Blue**
  brings a stronger temperature contrast. It can create a fresh whole, but also a hard contrast.
- **Black**
  strongly emphasises yellow. On a small detail it can be impressive, but in large contrasting patterns it already recalls signage that wants you to keep watching out.
- **Grey and white**
  A cleaner, calmer impression. Yellow easily stands out against them.

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Elements

In feng shui the elements are related to one another.

- **Fire creates earth**
  Terracotta, orange and warm reds warm yellow through.
- **Earth supports metal**
  White, grey and brass add restraint to yellow.
- **Wood pulls earth in**
  Green adds liveliness, but watch the proportion of the two colours.
- **Earth holds water**
  Symbolically blue and black belong here, which calm or cool yellow.

In the traditional cycle of five elements fire supports earth and earth supports metal. That is why symbolic designs add fiery or metallic elements to earthy yellows. But into a real room more than a table comes. A yellow linen curtain, a yellow plastic chair and a brass lamp have a different surface, reflection and overall impression. The practical question is therefore whether the room holds you pleasantly, or is already heavy, sharp or overcrowded.

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Feng shui room by room

What works – what to watch for – a simple tip.

Living room

What works. Yellow cushions, an armchair, a picture or flowers add **liveliness** to a calmer base. Butter and ochre feel cosier than a sharp lemon, especially next to cream, wood and muted green.

What to watch for. When you let yellow take over the sofa, curtains and wall, you may no longer feel pleasant warmth but the constant presence of one colour. Especially in a room into which the sun shines strongly.

A simple tip. Leave **one striking piece** and calmer materials around it. If you then rest better, the change of quantity made sense. A living room can be sunny without having its own heatstroke all year round.

Kitchen and bathroom

What works. In the kitchen yellow ceramics, a tablecloth or a smaller area on the wall connect with food, butter and shared meals. Butter and golden feel **kind**. In the bathroom a towel or ceramics in a sandy yellow next to white and wood is enough.

What to watch for. A sharp yellow next to a large amount of red and gloss can give the impression that something is always going on. At the mirror, moreover, the colour of the room meets how you perceive your own skin. Yellow-tinted light also distorts the look of food.

A simple tip. Try **a tablecloth, a bowl or a towel** first. Notice whether the space invites you to stay, or is so busy that you want to get everything done and leave.

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Bedroom

What works. A soft butter, vanilla or sandy yellow, or yellow in a small pattern, can be pleasant if you link it with **warmth and softness**. Start with bedding or a throw that you can easily swap.

What to watch for. Large rich areas and sharp contrasts can feel too lively in a room where you want to wind down in the evening. Look at the sample under a lamp too, because a tender yellow in the daytime can feel richer in the evening. The colour of a wall is not a treatment for insomnia.

A simple tip. Put a yellow throw on the bed and watch your impression for several evenings. Do you feel like snuggling in, or does the room feel **ready for a morning meeting**? Choose a gentler shade or a smaller area accordingly.

Children's room

What works. Yellow can accompany a creative corner, pictures or individual pieces of furniture, for example a box for building blocks or a small table. A child **can choose** which form is pleasant to them.

What to watch for. A whole room does not have to be richly yellow just because it is meant to feel cheerful. A child looks for fun in it during the day and is meant to fall asleep in it in the evening. Yellow by itself does not explain restlessness, and a different paint will not guarantee falling asleep on command.

A simple tip. Separate the livelier place for play from the **calmer surroundings of the bed**. By the bed try fewer contrasts and fewer objects. A child does not need to fall asleep in the middle of a graphic design for a children's festival.

Study

What works. Yellow can mark a place for ideas, a noticeboard or one important thing. In a studio it brings individuality. Try **one yellow detail** by work in progress and leave the surroundings in warm grey, cream and wood.

What to watch for. Everything highlighted means nothing highlighted. A rich and bright yellow can tire the eyes and distract. If you paint, photograph or judge shades, a large rich surrounding also influences how you perceive other colours.

A simple tip. Leave yellow for ideas and **a more neutral surface** for the work itself. During long concentration compare a sharp lemon with a muted ochre and choose next to which it is easier to work.

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Hall and entrance

What works. A smaller yellow picture or a light yellow detail can be **a personal welcome**. The benefit is a pleasant first look, something that delights you before you start dealing with put-down bags and post.

What to watch for. A yellow coat of paint does not create daylight where there is none. Under an unsuitable lamp the shade can look dirty or greenish. Gloss moreover strengthens the light that is often missing in a hall.

A simple tip. Try a sample directly under the light you will use. Does the entrance welcome you, or does **the first look shout** at you?

Ask yourself

“Why do I want yellow at home? What is it meant to bring me, light, warmth, or appetite?”

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Colour frequency and phototherapy

Muted yellow or amber light can recall a candle, an autumn afternoon or the sun on a table. It can create a **kinder** atmosphere than a harshly lit room. Let us say which of that is **atmosphere** and which is already **treatment**.

And this is exactly where it is good to put miraculous promises aside. Yellow light is not a magic lamp for hormones, mood or chakras.

Why warm light can be pleasant in the evening

Warm light contains little of the blue component and tends to be softer than cool white. In the evening it is easy to slow down in it. Less glare, gentler contrasts. For an evening routine, though, it is not only the shade that matters. It also depends on the brightness, the length of time the light is on and how much light falls into the eyes. A very bright yellow lamp right in front of your face is not automatically more suitable than a weak warm light out of direct view.

What you can try at home

In the evening switch off the large ceiling light and leave a smaller lamp on with a warm, muted light. So that you can see well and do not have to strain your eyes. **What it can bring you.** Less glare and an environment in which it is easier to move from activity to a calmer evening. During the day, on the other hand, do not shut yourself into a yellow half-light with the idea that it is beneficial in all circumstances. Daylight and evening quiet have different places in an ordinary day.

Where light is really studied

Blue-light glasses

Glasses that filter blue light (sometimes amber-tinted) are often offered, promising better sleep or less eye strain. A 2023 Cochrane review summarising 17 randomised trials, however, concluded that the evidence is inconclusive. For eye strain from computers there seems to be no short-term benefit, for sleep the effect is unclear. The studies did not assess long-term effects on the retina.

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Skin

Yellow and amber LED light around 590 nm penetrates the skin only about 0.5 to 2 millimetres and is studied mainly in skin ageing and as an adjunct after laser procedures. Smaller clinical studies follow, for example, sensitive skin, redness and the skin barrier, but the results are inconsistent. The results of a specific device and procedure cannot be transferred to every home lamp. If such treatment interests you, discuss its suitability with a dermatologist or another health professional experienced with the method.

Seasonal depression

For some difficulties light therapy is genuinely used, for example bright white light for seasonal depression. It is not a matter of surrounding yourself with the colour yellow or buying an ordinary yellow bulb. The choice of approach is guided by the specific problem, not by a favourite colour, and belongs in the hands of a doctor, especially with eye problems, certain medicines or bipolar disorder.

Yellow can delight you as a colour. Therapeutic light is judged by its specific purpose and parameters.

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Astrotype and colours

Are you Leo, Gemini, Virgo or another sign? The astrotype is **a much broader topic** than just the sun sign. If you really want to go into depth, knowing only your date of birth is not enough. The exact place and time of birth are also important, because only from them are the ascendant, the position of the Moon, planets and other parts of the horoscope calculated. Here, though, we stay only at the edge of what relates to colours.

According to astrological tradition yellow and gold belong to the Sun, which rules Leo. For Mercury, according to one source (digitalambler), a mix of colours including orange and blue is given. I place it among the fire signs (Aries, Leo, Sagittarius) as **the colour of light and warmth**. That is my own reflection in the spirit of the tradition, not a rule. Take it as a small colour excerpt from a much deeper topic.

The ascendant is the sign that was rising on the eastern horizon at the moment of your birth. According to astrological tradition it shows how you come across outwardly and how you enter the world, while the Sun sign describes more who you are inside. For each sign you will therefore find not only its character but also a short note on how the colour fits when it is your ascendant.

Aries (21 March – 19 April)

Your yellow

Warm yellow · amber · lemon

A yellow that gives **courage** but does not shout.

Aries is linked in astrology with Mars, fire and the start of spring. A warm yellow is for it **the light that gets the day going**, without the sharpness of red.

What Aries is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality cardinal · ruler Mars

Aries opens the zodiac and you can tell that it is first. It is a **pioneer** who gets into things before thinking them through perfectly. It is direct, impatient and likes to compete. It gets angry quickly but forgives quickly too.

Its strength is the **courage** to begin. Weaker is perseverance in long, slow matters. It does best where something is happening and where it can act at once.

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What it can support in you

Aries is quick and direct. **Yellow gives you the courage to begin and light for the day.**

It suits moments when you want energy but do not want to collide with things needlessly.

Shadow competing for your own worth

In the shadow Aries proves it has what it takes. Confidence turns into a need to win and every failure hits harder than it should.

Aries does not like delay. A yellow that is too sharp can set you running even more.

When you add gas where things are already going fast enough, impatience comes and ten things in progress.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you stand by yourself and **decide** without needless haste.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mars red as an accent. When there is too much of it, this helps.

- Mars red as an accent
- cream
- light blue

Cream and light blue slow the pace without taking away your light.

Aries as ascendant

When Aries is your ascendant, you come across as direct, lively and decisive. People may see you as someone who gets straight to the point, and the first impression tends to be brisk.

Yellow strengthens your confidence, but let it not start to look like an order.

In everyday life

*Keep yellow for moments when you want **light without kicking the door in**. A scarf, a mug, one piece of furniture.*

*When you get carried away, **try** butter. It will remind you that a start can be soft too.*

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Taurus (20 April – 20 May)

Your yellow

Butter · golden · ochre

A yellow that **you can** feel with your hands. Butter, honey, wood.

Taurus is an earth sign linked with Venus, the senses and stability. A golden and butter yellow gives it **warmth and relish**, for example in food, wood and ceramics.

What Taurus is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality fixed · ruler Venus

Taurus is an earthy, **patient** and sensual sign. It likes good food, pleasant materials, nature and security. It gets going slowly, but once it decides on something, it persists.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to enjoy the present moment. The weaker side tends to be stubbornness and finding it hard to let go of what is familiar.

What it can support in you

Taurus likes sensuality and **security**. **A golden and butter yellow gives you warmth and relish.**

With Taurus it is often not only about the colour but about the material. Yellow on a clay bowl or on a linen tablecloth feels entirely different from glossy plastic.

Shadow insisting on principle

In the shadow Taurus decides firmly and never reconsiders. Will stiffens into stubbornness and worth is measured by not giving way.

Taurus needs tangibility. A garish yellow may feel unpleasant to you.

And once you have got used to something, you do not want to let go of anything you know. Warm and dense shades may further support the feeling that nothing is moving.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you believe in your own worth and **trust** your pace.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Venus green or pink and something **light**.

Soft green · pink · cream · light wood

They add more **lightness** and **freshness**.

Taurus as ascendant

When Taurus is your ascendant, you come across as calm, stable and pleasant. You build trust slowly and people often feel firm ground in you.

A butter or ochre yellow suits it, a sharp lemon is rather restless.

In everyday life

*Yellow may remind you that **pleasure is not a reward for performance**.*

***You can** have something nice without having to earn it first with three completed tasks.*

Gemini (21 May – 20 June)

Your yellow

Lemon · warm yellow · pastel

A playful yellow that does not stay long in one place.

Gemini is linked with Mercury, movement and curiosity. Yellow suits it as **the colour of ideas and quick thinking**.

What Gemini is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Gemini is **curious**, talkative and adaptable. It learns quickly, likes to tell stories and enjoys it when a lot is going on around it. It can see several sides of one thing.

Its strength is **lightness** and wit. The weaker side tends to be scatteredness and a tendency to start more things than can be finished.

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What it can support in you

Gemini is playful and curious. **Yellow is the colour of ideas and thinking, your playful colour.**

When you are bored, it can wake you up quickly. And Gemini really cannot be bored for long.

Shadow thinking instead of deciding

In the shadow Gemini weighs things endlessly. The mind offers arguments for everything and its own will is lost among them.

Gemini gets bored quickly. Too much yellow can distract you.

Too many ideas and colours at once can end with an unfinished diary and five books started.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **focus** ideas and see them through.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mercury blue or orange. For a breather this helps.

Mercury blue · orange · light blue

Blue tidies up attention, orange keeps the play alive.

Gemini as ascendant

When Gemini is your ascendant, you come across as lively, friendly and chatty. People may see you as curious and youthful, even if inside you are perhaps calmer.

Yellow is their natural colour and it looks fresh.

In everyday life

*Put yellow where **playfulness and conversation** fit. A table for guests, a notebook, a mug.*

For days when your head is racing choose a gentler shade and leave just one yellow detail.

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Cancer (21 June – 22 July)

Your yellow

Butter · sand · honey

A soft yellow that warms and does not speak loudly.

Cancer is linked with the Moon, water and the start of summer. It is caring and sensitive. A soft yellow is for it **like milk with honey**, cosy and warming.

What Cancer is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality cardinal · ruler Moon

Cancer is **caring**, sensitive and strongly connected to home and family. It has a good memory for feelings and relationships. It enters the world cautiously, much like a crab with its shell.

Its strength is **empathy** and the ability to create safety. The weaker side tends to be changeable moods and a tendency to withdraw when it feels hurt.

What it can support in you

Cancer is caring and sensitive. **A soft yellow is like milk with honey, cosy and warming.**

With Cancer it is important that the colour is not “public”. Yellow suits it on a blanket, a mug and lamplight.

Shadow doubt about your own place

In the shadow Cancer asks whether it has the right to want. It would rather give way and withdraw so as not to burden anyone.

Cancer is vulnerable. A sharp yellow can strengthen nervousness and anxiety.

And when you are already caring for everyone, another warming colour may remind you that it is you who keeps warming.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you bring in a little **light** and the courage to say what you need.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Moon white and silver. They bring back **calm**.

White · silver · light blue

They add coolness and softness so that the warmth does not overflow.

Cancer as ascendant

When Cancer is your ascendant, you come across as gentle and careful. At first you keep your distance, but then warmth unfolds and people see in you someone who will look after them.

A butter or vanilla yellow, like morning light, suits it.

In everyday life

*Yellow in a soft fabric and in evening light is **safest** for you.*

***Give yourself** something warming just for yourself, not only for others.*

Leo (23 July – 22 August)

Your yellow

Gold · amber · sun yellow

A yellow that shines, but with **dignity**.

Leo is linked with the Sun, fire and the peak of summer. Yellow and gold are directly the colours of its ruler and give you **dignified joy**.

What Leo is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality fixed · ruler Sun

Leo is **generous**, proud and creative. It likes to give, likes to rejoice and needs others to see and appreciate it. It is loyal and has a big heart.

Its strength is **warmth** and the ability to inspire others. The weaker side tends to be sensitivity to criticism and a tendency to want to be the centre of attention.

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What it can support in you

Leo wants to shine. **Yellow and gold are directly the colours of your ruler, the Sun, and add dignity.**

A golden yellow gives it a reason to, without its having to raise its voice.

Shadow vulnerable pride

In the shadow Leo leans on recognition for its own worth. Criticism hits it like a loss of dignity.

Leo does not want to go unnoticed. A yellow that is too garish can look like a bid for attention.

And when you want everyone to see you, it can tire you that everyone sees you.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **shine** and be yourself.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Stick to **sun gold** and warm white.

Sun gold · warm white · dark red

A soft gold is more dignified than a rich and garish one.

Leo as ascendant

When Leo is your ascendant, you come across as self-assured, warm and striking. You enter a room in a way that people notice you even when you do not want them to.

Gold and yellow are close to it because they reflect the sun.

In everyday life

*Yellow suits moments when **something has gone well** for you.*

*When it becomes a uniform, **try** swapping it for something calmer for a day.*

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Virgo (23 August – 22 September)

Your yellow

Light yellow · butter · sand

A yellow that brings clarity but does not upset order.

Virgo is linked with Mercury, earth and the end of summer. It loves order and clarity, which is why **light, clean shades** suit it.

What Virgo is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Virgo is **meticulous**, attentive and practical. It notices details that others overlook and likes to be useful. It tends to be modest and judges itself more strictly than others.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to improve things. The weaker side tends to be perfectionism, worries and a tendency to criticise itself.

What it can support in you

Virgo loves order and clarity. **A light yellow gives you clarity and freshness without noise.**

It works well in a small dose. A cushion, a mug, one yellow detail in a light room.

Shadow comparing and self-doubt

In the shadow Virgo measures itself by other people's yardsticks and never meets them. Its own judgment drowns in checking details.

Virgo is critical, above all of itself. A sharp yellow can strengthen the critical inner voice.

And when you are strict with yourself, even a cheerful colour can start to serve as another item on the list.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you ease off perfectionism and have **trust** in your own judgment.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mercury blue or white. They bring clarity.

Mercury blue · white · light grey

Clean surfaces make room so that yellow does not feel like clutter.

Virgo as ascendant

When Virgo is your ascendant, you come across as neat, restrained and reliable. People see you as observant and sensible, sometimes even overly reserved.

A muted yellow, mustard or ochre, suits it, a sharp yellow would disturb.

In everyday life

*Yellow may remind you that **done does not have to be perfect**.*

***Try** it on things that do not have to be useful.*

Libra (23 September – 22 October)

Your yellow

Pastel · butter · light yellow

A pastel yellow with charm.

Libra is linked with Venus, air and the start of autumn. It seeks balance and beauty, and so **yellow in pastel shades** suits it.

What Libra is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality cardinal · ruler Venus

Libra longs for **harmony**, beauty and justice. It is diplomatic, sociable and has a feel for aesthetics. It lives best in relationships in which it does not feel alone.

Its strength is **tact** and the ability to see both sides. The weaker side tends to be hesitation and a tendency to avoid conflict even when it would help.

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What it can support in you

Libra seeks balance and beauty. **A pastel yellow brings you lightness and harmony.**

Libra has a feeling for proportions. It knows how much yellow still adorns.

Shadow hesitating between your own and others' will

In the shadow Libra does not know what it wants, because it sees what others want. Decisions are postponed so that no conflict arises.

Libra finds it hard to decide. A muted, greyish yellow may feel dirty to you.

The search for the perfect shade of yellow easily turns into long comparing that no longer entertains even you.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you decide from **your own centre**, not according to what others want.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Venus green, pink or white. They keep the balance.

Venus green · pink · white

Soft colours around it leave it its charm without drama.

Libra as ascendant

When Libra is your ascendant, you come across as elegant, pleasant and balanced. People like you for your tact, even if inside you take a long time to decide.

A soft yellow is light and pleasant, a strong one would disturb the harmony.

In everyday life

*Choose one shade and **live with it for a week**. A decision is sometimes born only when we live with a colour for a while.*

*Put yellow where **you will** look at beauty. A vase, a tablecloth, a scarf.*

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Scorpio (23 October – 21 November)

Your yellow

Deep gold · ochre · mustard

A gold with depth, like old honey or ochre.

Scorpio is in tradition linked with Mars, water and autumn. It likes depth and intensity, which is why its yellow is **muted and golden**.

What Scorpio is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality fixed · ruler Mars, in the newer view also Pluto

Scorpio is **intense**, deep and loyal. It feels strongly, but does not always show it. It dislikes superficiality and likes to get to what is hidden.

Its strength is **determination** and the ability to transform. The weaker side tends to be distrust, jealousy and a need to keep things under control.

What it can support in you

Scorpio likes depth and intensity. **A deep gold and ochre has weight and mystery.**

With Scorpio it is about the feeling that the colour knows something and does not need to talk about it.

Shadow control as power

In the shadow Scorpio holds the reins tight. Strength of will turns into a need to have everything under watch.

Scorpio cannot stand superficiality. A cheerful lemon yellow may feel superficial to you.

And a deep colour easily turns dark when something is troubling you. **Try** then not to add another heavy layer.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you show **strength** and accept your own power.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Mars dark red suits a muted gold. When you need light.

Mars dark red · cream · lemon

Cream and lemon let air into the depth.

Scorpio as ascendant

When Scorpio is your ascendant, you come across as focused, mysterious and strong. People sense the intensity of your gaze and often feel that you know more than you say.

Gold and mustard add a dignified note, a bright yellow is too revealing for it.

In everyday life

Yellow suits a deep earthy form. Ceramics, wood, wool.

***Treat yourself** to one cheerful thing that does not have to be deep.*

Sagittarius (22 November – 21 December)

Your yellow

Warm yellow · amber · lemon

The yellow of journeys, sun and **enthusiasm**.

Sagittarius is linked with Jupiter, fire and late autumn. It loves freedom and travel. Yellow is for it **the colour of sun on the road** and of **optimism**.

What Sagittarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter

Sagittarius is **optimistic**, open and free-spirited. It loves travel, new experiences and the search for meaning. It speaks honestly, sometimes a little too directly.

Its strength is **enthusiasm** and faith in a good outcome. The weaker side tends to be impatience with detail and a tendency to promise more than can be managed.

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What it can support in you

Sagittarius loves freedom and travel. **Yellow is the colour of sun on the road, of freedom and optimism.**

Sagittarius will carry it on a scarf, a rucksack or a map.

Shadow confidence without a base

In the shadow Sagittarius overestimates its strength and leaves details aside. Faith in itself parts from reality.

Sagittarius hates restrictions. **Too much yellow can cause restlessness.**

And **optimism** can turn into “it will somehow work out”.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **trust** your own direction and set off on it.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Jupiter blue or green. They give distance.

- Jupiter blue
- green
- light blue

Blue and green add a horizon.

Sagittarius as ascendant

When Sagittarius is your ascendant, you come across as open, jovial and adventurous. People see you as someone with a wide outlook and an appetite for discovery.

A sunny yellow is its natural colour.

In everyday life

*Yellow may remind you that **the journey is also at home**.*

Sit for a while at sunset and do not think about the next destination.

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Capricorn (22 December – 19 January)

Your yellow

Gold · mustard · ochre

Warmth without distraction. Gold and mustard.

Capricorn is linked with Saturn, earth and winter. It is practical and persevering. A golden and mustard yellow gives it **warmth without distraction**.

What Capricorn is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality cardinal · ruler Saturn

Capricorn is **responsible**, goal-oriented and disciplined. It likes to build and is not afraid of a long road. It has a dry sense of humour and shows it only to those it trusts.

Its strength is **perseverance** and the ability to see things through. The weaker side tends to be strictness with itself, reserve and a tendency to put joy off until later.

What it can support in you

Capricorn is practical and persevering. **A golden and mustard yellow feels dignified and calm.**

It carries it well on materials that last. Ceramics, wood, leather.

Shadow worth measured by performance

In the shadow Capricorn feels its worth only when it achieves something. Rest evokes a feeling of guilt in it.

Capricorn is strict with itself. A radiant yellow may feel too cheerful to you.

And when you endure for a long time, **you may** forget that warmth belongs to you too.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you ease the pressure to perform and take **joy** in what you have already achieved.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add **something just for joy**. Soft materials and a warm colour.

cream · olive · brown

Soft materials and a warm colour that does not have to achieve anything.

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Capricorn as ascendant

When Capricorn is your ascendant, you come across as serious, mature and reserved. People may see you as older than you are, and only later discover how funny you are.

Mustard or gold adds warmth without losing dignity.

In everyday life

*Take yellow into winter, as **a lamp or a blanket**.*

***Treat yourself** to something with no purpose and no result.*

Aquarius (20 January – 18 February)

Your yellow

Warm yellow · lemon · with turquoise

Yellow as an unexpected accent.

Aquarius is in tradition linked with Saturn, air and winter. It likes distance and independence. Yellow is for it **an unusual accent** that catches the eye.

What Aquarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality fixed · ruler Saturn, in the newer view also Uranus

Aquarius is **independent**, original and idealistic. It is interested in ideas, humanity and the future. It wants to go its own way and does not like adapting to expectations.

Its strength is **perspective** and the ability to come up with new things. The weaker side tends to be distance from feelings and a tendency to withdraw when there is too much closeness.

What it can support in you

Aquarius likes distance and independence. **Yellow is an unusual accent that catches the eye.**

It suits where you do not want to blend in.

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Shadow cool detachment

In the shadow Aquarius leans on reason and withdraws from feelings. It defends its own will by distance.

Aquarius does not like predictability. As a main colour it may feel too obvious to you.

And if the colour starts to carry you into the role of “the one who brings light”, your own peculiarity may slip away from you.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **trust** your own ideas.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add **one unexpected colour accent**.

Turquoise · grey · indigo

A cool counterpart underlines that yellow is your choice, not a duty.

Aquarius as ascendant

When Aquarius is your ascendant, you come across as independent, a little unusual and friendly. People see you as an original personality who keeps their own space.

Yellow combined with violet or grey underlines originality.

In everyday life

*Yellow on a single object (a lamp, socks, an envelope) works **better than a whole outfit**.*

***Try** it in a place where nobody expects it.*

Pisces (19 February – 20 March)

Your yellow

Butter · light yellow · sand

Butter like light shining through water.

Pisces is in tradition linked with Jupiter, water and the end of winter. They love dreams and gentleness. A light butter yellow is **like light shining through water**.

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What Pisces is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter, in the newer view also Neptune

Pisces is **empathic**, intuitive and dreamy. It picks up the moods around it and often has a rich imagination. It frequently has a bond with art, music and spirituality.

Its strength is **compassion** and creative fantasy. The weaker side tends to be merging with other people's feelings, escaping into dreams and difficulty setting boundaries.

What it can support in you

Pisces love dreams and gentleness. **A soft butter yellow is like light that shines through water.**

It is best carried by soft, bleeding surfaces.

Shadow loss of your own direction

In the shadow Pisces take on other people's wishes and lose what they want themselves. They leave decisions to fate.

Pisces easily dissolve. A sharp yellow can pull you out of your inner world.

And when you escape into dreaming, another bright colour will not help you back into the world.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you bring **clarity** and decision into dreaming.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Jupiter blue and green, soft shades of water.

Jupiter blue · green · light blue

Water calms and grounds.

Pisces as ascendant

When Pisces is your ascendant, you come across as gentle, dreamy and adaptable. People like to project their wishes onto you and tend to be kind to you.

A pastel yellow such as vanilla or butter suits them, a rich yellow would overpower the gentleness.

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In everyday life

*Butter can remind you that **gentleness is strength**.*

When the day dissolves for you, do one small thing with your hands.

FOR A DEEPER LOOK

Seasons

Yellow is the colour of summer, sunlight and fields. Leo belongs to summer, Cancer and Gemini to its start. **Ask yourself when you reach for yellow**.

Time of day

Yellow is the colour of morning light and of mid-morning. **In the evening it can be too sharp unless it is muted**.

Years of life

Saturn returns to the place where it stood at your birth, at roughly 27 to 31 years of age and again between 56 and 60. Astrology reads it as a time of re-evaluation and new order. In those years yellow may feel close to you, or on the contrary foreign. **Both are natural.**

Why liking changes

Research by Palmer and Schloss (2010) states that **we like colours according to the things and experiences we link with them**. Astrology does not rule this out, it just offers **another view**.

A question for you

“When do you like yellow more? Morning, evening, summer, winter?”

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Colour for your website and business

Yes – but more as a bright accent than as the main voice.

In business yellow is the colour that lifts its head and says “Hey, here I am!” It is **the most visible of colours**, and so it is good to know **when it shouts usefully and when it is merely loud**. This part is not a guide to what you must do, just an aid so you know what yellow promises before you let it into a logo, a website or an advert.

By itself, though, it **does not attract customers** like a magnet. It can help **catch** attention and create **a light, welcoming impression**, but what still decides is mainly what you sell, to whom and how well it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Yellow can say, for example

“Hey, here I am.” “Something is happening here.” “Come and look.” “Watch out, this is important.”

- **Optimism and lightness.** Yellow is most often linked with **joy**, humour and spontaneity. It suits where you want to improve the mood.
- **Attention.** It is the lightest, and so the eye catches it first. That is why it is used on signs, warnings and notices.
- **Friendliness and youth.** It invites **playfulness** and ideas.
- Caution and care. In the world of traffic yellow means “watch out”. It can thus evoke caution.
- **Legibility.** Yellow text on white is hard to read. What works best is a yellow area with dark (black) lettering.

Depending on the shade, though, it can also feel different. A rich lemon is **more active** and **louder**, butter and sand feel **warm and soft**, gold **festive**, ochre and mustard **earthy and crafted**.

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Simple tips

Yellow as a background, dark lettering

Black or dark lettering on a yellow area reads well, white does not. The most visible pair is yellow with black, and grey, blue and violet (its opposite) also suit it.

Shade by role

Rich yellow for attention and action, butter and sand for warmth, gold for festivity, ochre and mustard for earthiness and craft.

Cultural context

In China and Southeast Asia yellow is the colour of dignity and royal power, in Europe it can also carry old meanings of betrayal and shame. Before you set out into the world, find out what yellow means with you and with them.

Colour blindness

About 1 in 12 men has trouble telling red and green apart. Do not use these two colours as the only difference between two things.

Not the whole website

Large bright areas tire and put customers off.

Yellow as an accent

A button or highlight on a calm background. It is visible and does not shout.

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Professions where it is a Yes

It suits **children, education and play**, creative and entertainment brands, food and breakfast, cafés, travel and sunny services, transport and logistics (taxis, post), **safety and signage**, startups and brands that want to catch attention. Also the personal brand of a woman who wants to be seen, cheerful and imaginative.

Café, bakery, small bistro

Yellow can tell a story of warmth, freshness and a pleasant meeting. **Try an ochre sign, a butter-coloured packaging or a yellow detail on the menu.** For a quiet café a softer shade may feel nicer than a sharp combination of yellow and black. The guest has come for a coffee, not to check the state of the road.

Children's and playful projects

For play, ideas or informal education yellow can be a lovely part of a brand. **But give it space next to a calmer base.** When every picture starts shouting in colour, there is no room left for what you really want to say.

Culture, design and a personal brand

Yellow can be **bold** without the same story of passion that red often tells. It can feel **playful, unexpected or lightly provocative**. **Try** one yellow motif on a poster or a detail next to a photograph of your own work. It is meant to introduce you, not to out-shout you in colour.

Care, rest and sensitive topics

Here I would try gentler shades and a smaller amount. If women arrive tired, there is no need for compulsory sunshine to greet them at the door. Ask what the visitor should expect. **Playfulness and meeting**, or **quiet and relief**? Yellow can be part of both, but each time differently.

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Professions where it is a No

It does not suit **prestigious finance, law and luxury,** where yellow can feel loud and cheap (gold yes, yellow less so). Also **calm** and sleep (meditation, therapy) and everywhere you want to appear long-term and restrained. A richly yellow website with white text will unfortunately be unreadable.

This is not a ban on yellow for a whole field. What decides is how much of it you use, what shade it has and what a woman is meeting at your place right now. Here, though, I would be sparing with a large radiant area.

- **Funeral services, accompaniment in grief, crisis help**. A cheerful lemon across a whole website can feel as if there were no room for the other side's **pain**. A woman needs to feel she can come here even without a smile. I would choose a calmer base; a soft warm detail may stay if it belongs naturally in the whole.
- **Massage for deep rest, a meditation space, evening relaxation**. If you promise stillness, a large sharp yellow and black contrasts may visually tell more of bustle and activity. **Try** butter, sand or yellow only in a detail. The client came to put the day down, not to take on another shift in the sun.
- **Law, accounting, financial advice**. When a woman is dealing with obligations or a contract, she needs clarity and a sense of reliability. A playful yellow across a whole presentation can overshadow the seriousness of the service. As a detail next to a restrained base, though, it can pleasantly distinguish the brand. A yellow logo by itself does not lower trustworthiness; judge the whole impression.
- **A brand built on quiet elegance and privacy**. A garishly yellow packaging can drown out exactly the subtlety for which a woman chose you. A small yellow element or a more muted shade can give the product room and still keep its individuality.

The rule is simple. When you sell **joy**, an idea and catching attention, yellow will help you. When you sell **calm** and prestige, it will be too loud.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer, and ask “What would you expect from such a place or service?” **Is the offer visible, or mainly the yellow?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that yellow means optimism.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

Examples from the market

You know yellow from shops, adverts and the street. Here are a few examples that show what it can do.

- **McDonald's (fast food)**
  The first franchise restaurant with the double arches opened in May 1953 in Phoenix, Arizona. Two arches of yellow sheet metal with neon were already called golden at the design stage. Today's form of the arches logo dates from 1968. Yellow here is a trademark that you remember.

- **Post-it (office supplies)**
  The yellow paper of the notes was not a thought-out intention. According to the available sources it was scrap paper from a neighbouring laboratory. In 1977 the notes were test-sold as Press ’n Peel, in 1978 they got the name Post-it and in 1980 they came to market across the USA. Aha. A colour does not have to be planned to become a trademark.

- **DHL (courier services)**
  The company was founded in 1969 and the first logo had white letters on a red background. A yellow background with red lettering came with the takeover by Deutsche Post. According to the company yellow is linked with speed, which suits logistics.

- **Timberland (footwear)**
  The boot came out in 1973 and is still called the Yellow Boot. It is the brand's best-known model and the colour became a name.

What they have in common is that yellow carries a simple message. Watch out, visible, playful. And it is mostly not everywhere, only where it is meant to stand out.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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Different colour combinations

Yellow + red

How it feels

Hot, striking, loud. Red is warm and strong, and with yellow it forms a hot pair (fast food, advertising flyers).

When it suits

When you want **energy and attention**.

Specific shades



yellow + red
striking



golden + crimson
serious and warm



lemon + scarlet
fresh



ochre + brick
earthy



sunflower + wine
deep

In practice

A yellow and a red cushion. Red lipstick and a yellow scarf.

Watch out

Large areas of both can feel **garish**.

Yellow + orange

How it feels

Sunny, joyful. Orange is its warm neighbour, together they are like a setting sun.

When it suits

When you want a **festive, sunny** mood and warmth.

Specific shades



yellow + orange
striking



ochre + terracotta
earthy and calm



butter + apricot
gentle



golden + pumpkin
autumnal



sunflower + mandarin
playful

In practice

Yellow and orange flowers. A kitchen in warm tones.

Watch out

Rich yellow and rich orange can recall **fast food** or **warning graphics**.

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Yellow + green

How it feels

Fresh, spring-like. Green is yellow's other neighbour, mixed they give a spring yellow-green, lime.

When it suits

When you want **freshness and brightening**, even in the middle of winter.

Specific shades



yellow + green
naturally



ochre + sage
gentle and earthy



sunflower + dark green
rich



lemon + mint
fresh



golden + moss
woodland

In practice

Lime and green in a kitchen. A yellow scarf and a green coat.

Watch out

Yellow-green can be **sour**.

Yellow + blue

How it feels

Fresh and confident. Blue gives **calm**, yellow light. It is a classic pair you know from flags and from some brands. Mixed they give green.

When it suits

When you want **freshness and certainty**.

Specific shades



yellow + cobalt
striking



ochre + denim
earthy and calm



butter + light blue
gentle



golden + petrol
deep



vanilla + grey-blue
quiet

In practice

A yellow accessory in a blue room. Blue jeans and a yellow jumper.

Watch out

When there is too much yellow, it feels **garish**.

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Yellow + indigo

How it feels

Dramatic, deep. Indigo is a deep, dark blue-violet, and with yellow it forms a strong contrast, like gold in the evening sky.

When it suits

When you want **light in the dark**.

Specific shades


golden + indigo
deep


ochre + ink
dramatic


sunflower + midnight
evening-like


butter + plum blue
muted


yellow + navy
rich

In practice

An indigo wall with a yellow lamp. Evening lighting.

Watch out

A strong contrast feels dramatic, so dose it.

Yellow + violet

How it feels

Magical and playful. Violet is yellow's opposite on the colour wheel, the strongest contrast. Each makes the other glow.

When it suits

When you want something **magical and playful**. Yellow lights violet up and violet deepens yellow.

Specific shades


sunflower + purple
boldly


butter + lavender
tenderly


golden + plum
deeply


yellow + amethyst
playfully


vanilla + lilac
gently

In practice

Yellow flowers and a violet vase. A violet scarf and a yellow bag.

Watch out

Mixed together they turn grey.

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Yellow + pink

How it feels

Tender and cheerful. Pink is red diluted with white, and with yellow it forms sorbet-like, summery shades.

When it suits

When you want a **playful and kind** pair.

Specific shades



butter + powder
tenderly



sunflower + pale pink
playfully



ochre + dusty pink
earthy and gentle



yellow + fuchsia
boldly



golden + salmon
warmly

In practice

Powder pink and butter yellow in a room. A pink jumper and a yellow scarf.

Watch out

Watch that it is not **too sweet**.

Yellow + grey

How it feels

Modern and calm. Grey mutes and firms up yellow, and yellow enlivens grey.

When it suits

When there is too much of everything. Grey-yellow is widely used today.

Specific shades



sunflower + anthracite
modern



butter + light grey
calm



vanilla + dove
gentle



golden + slate
elegant



lemon + silver-grey
quiet

In practice

A grey sofa and a yellow cushion. A grey dress and a yellow scarf.

Watch out

Grey should not **drown out** yellow, give it the floor.

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Yellow + brown

How it feels

Earthy, safe. Brown and yellow are a natural pair. Ochre, mustard, clay. Yellow warms, brown holds.

When it suits

When you want **support and warmth**, a feeling of home.

Specific shades



sunflower + chocolate
richly



butter + caramel
softly



ochre + dark wood
earthy



golden + chestnut
autumnal



vanilla + beige
gently

In practice

Wooden furniture and yellow textiles. Mustard and brown.

Watch out

Brown can take command, leave yellow **enough room**.

Yellow + white

How it feels

Fresh and bright. White gives yellow space. Yellow breathes and white gives room.

When it suits

When you want a **clean, airy** impression.

Specific shades



lemon + pure white
fresh



butter + cream
soft



vanilla + milky
quiet



ochre + ivory
natural



yellow + linen
calm

In practice

A white kitchen with a yellow accessory. A white shirt and a yellow scarf.

Watch out

Yellow stands out next to white, but on white it can be **hard to read**. Watch for weak contrast.

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Yellow + black

How it feels

Strong and warning. Black and yellow are the most visible pair of all. Bees, warnings, taxis, signage.

When it suits

When you want **strong contrast and attention**.

Specific shades



yellow + black
striking



golden + charcoal
elegant



butter + graphite
gentle



sunflower + anthracite
rich



lemon + black
dark

In practice

Black accessories and a yellow accent. A black bag with a yellow scarf.

Watch out

When there is too much, it feels **noisy**.

Yellow + gold

How it feels

Sun and honey. Yellow makes gold glow and gold gives yellow depth. Together they feel joyful and warming.

When it suits

When you want **light and joy**.

Specific shades



yellow + gold
cheerful



ochre + antique gold
golden



butter + champagne
fresh



lemon + rich gold
radiant



mustard + matt gold
muted

In practice

A yellow scarf and gold jewellery. A yellow wall and a gold frame.

Watch out

At the same intensity the colours pull against each other. Leave gold **as an accent**.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to **mute and firm up** yellow, add **grey**, **white** or **blue**.
- When you want to **ground** it, add **brown**, **ochre** or **natural materials**.
- When you want to **freshen** it, add **green** or **turquoise**.
- When you want to **make it glow**, **violet**, **indigo** or **black** will help.

Colour theory and symbolism are inspiration, not a rule. The best measure is how you really feel next to the colour.

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